EXPERIMENT 11

DEPLOYING A ZOHO CREATOR APPLICATION FROM DEVELOPMENT TO PRODUCTION ENVIRONMENT

Bank Loan Application Form

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SUBMITTED BY

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1. Aim

To deploy the Bank Loan Application Form developed in Zoho Creator from the Development environment to the Stage environment for testing and subsequently to the Production environment, ensuring that the tested and approved version becomes available to end users.

The application manages loan applications containing applicant information, contact details, application and repayment dates, interest rates, loan reasons, and supporting documents. Because a live application of this kind is used by real applicants, changes to it should be reviewed and tested before release, which is why a controlled, staged deployment is used.

2. Application Overview

The Bank Loan Application Form application is used to manage loan applications. Its dashboard presents charts and summary tiles for the applications, including tiles for applications that are pending and applications that have been rejected.

This small modification is used to demonstrate how a change moves from Development through Stage to Production.

3. Deployment Concept and Multi-Stage Model

Zoho Creator provides three environments. A change is published to one environment at a time, so untested work does not reach live users.

Environment	Purpose	Version progression in this experiment
Development	The environment where the application is built or modified.	Note field modified; changes published as V1.1.
Stage	A testing copy used to check changes before they are released.	Received version 1.1; the updated note was checked on the form.
Production	The live environment used by end users.	Held version 1.0 initially; version 1.1 after publishing from Stage.

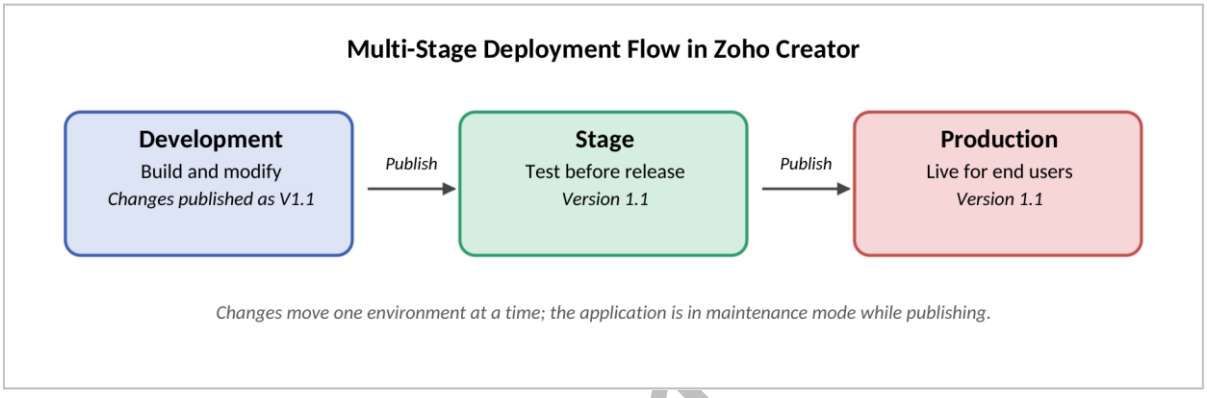
3.1 Deployment flow



The sequence followed in this experiment was as follows:

1. Production initially held version 1.0.
2. A small modification was made to the loan application form in Development.
3. The modified application was published to Stage as version 1.1.
4. The change was checked in Stage.
5. Version 1.1 was subsequently published to Production.

Changes move through the environments in sequence, and publishing may temporarily place the application in maintenance mode, as indicated in the source record. The original multi-stage deployment diagram is reproduced below.



Multi-stage deployment flow in Zoho Creator (original diagram)

4. Procedure

The deployment was carried out in seven steps. The screenshots captured during the deployment are placed with the step they belong to.

Step 1 Review the application in Development

The Bank Loan Application Form application was opened in Development and its dashboard was reviewed. The dashboard contains charts and summary tiles for the loan applications, including tiles for applications that are pending and applications that have been rejected.



Fig. 1 — Application dashboard showing charts and summary tiles

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Step 2 Open the Environments page

The Environments page was opened by navigating to Deploy → Environments. The page lists the Stage and Production environments. When it was first opened, Production held version 1.0, while the Stage column showed the message “Waiting for development app creation” because Creator was still setting up the Development copy. After a small change was saved in the loan application form, the label “Changes available” indicated that Development had changes ready to publish.

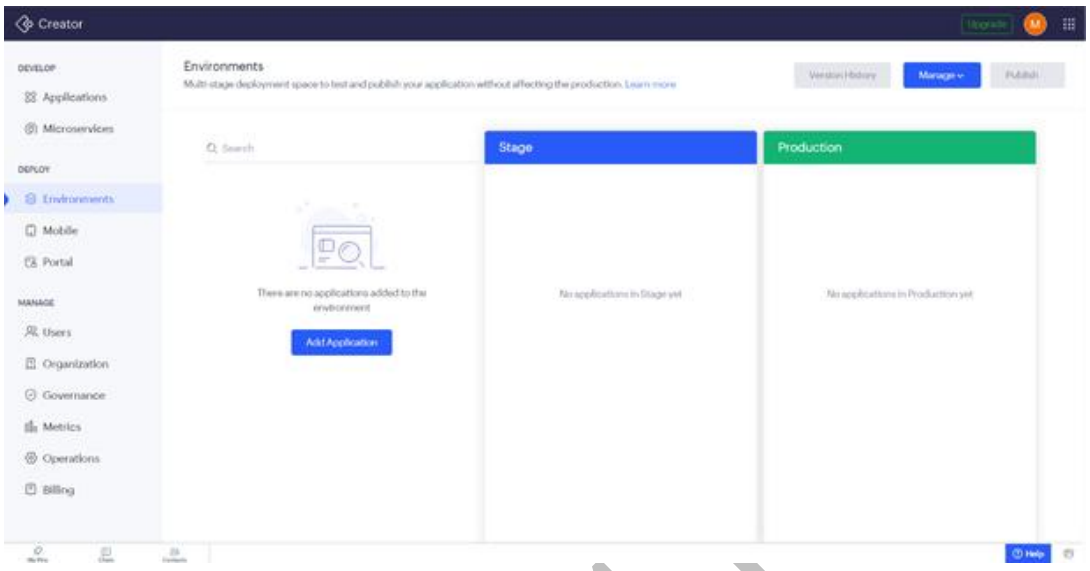


Fig. 2 — Environments page with Stage and Production columns (Production version 1.0)

Step 3 Select components for Stage deployment

Publish → Publish to Stage was chosen. In the Publish to Stage window, the modified component was selected through Forms → loan application → Fields. The modified note field (plain) in the Section of the form was selected, and the Development and Staging code were compared side by side. The Development code contains the updated note text, while the Staging code still holds the earlier text.

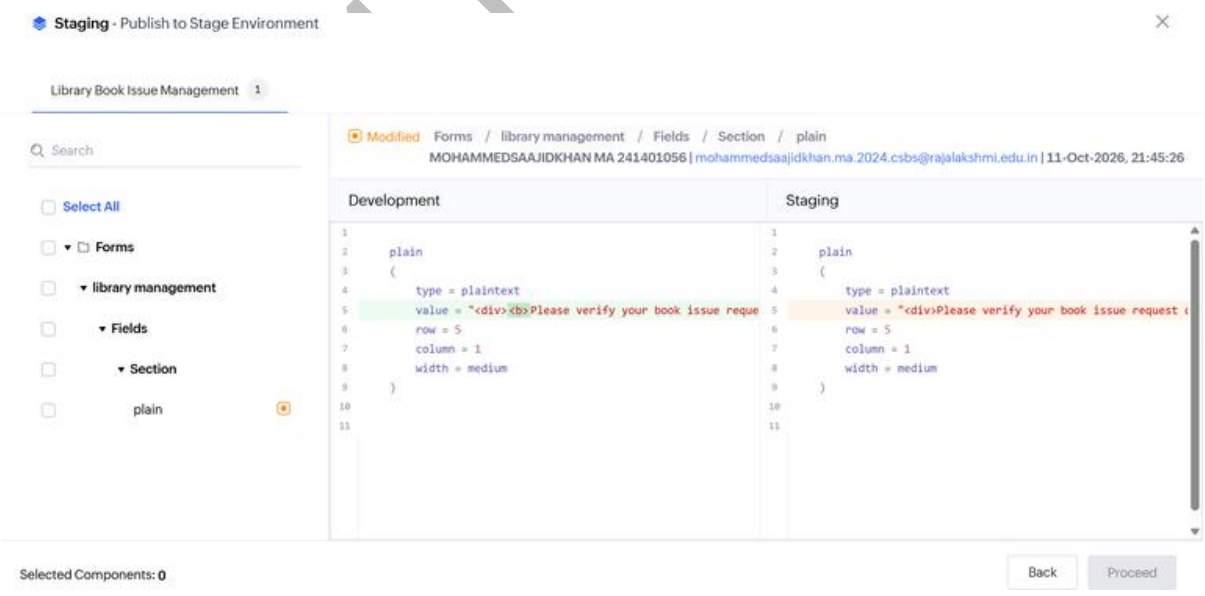


Fig. 3 — Component selection and Development vs Staging code comparison

Step 4 Enter the publish details

The following publish details were entered:

Field	Entry
Title	Bank Loan Application Form – Initial
Description	Initial deployment of the Bank Loan Application Form application from Development to Stage for testing.
Version type	Minor (minimal changes and bug fixes)
Version change	V1.0 to V1.1
Email notification	Sent to the developer's registered email address

A warning on the form stated that the application will be set to maintenance mode and will be inaccessible until publishing is complete. The form was then published.

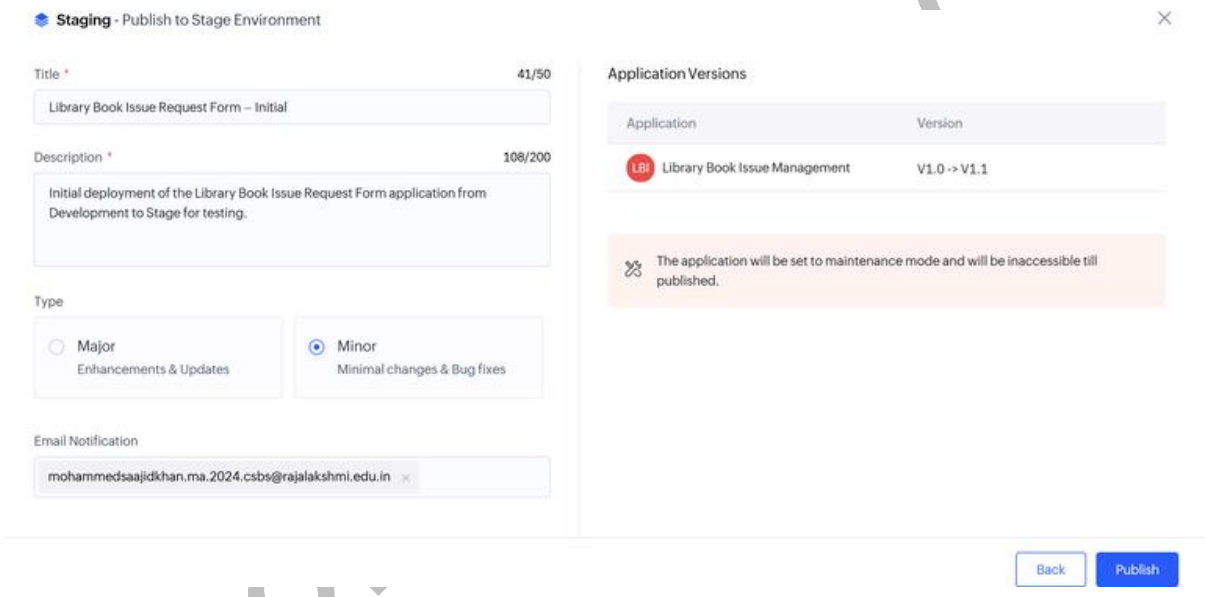


Fig. 4 — Publish to Stage form with title, description, type and version change

Step 5 Confirm the Stage deployment

After Publish was selected, Zoho Creator displayed the message "Publish to Stage initiated" and indicated that the process takes a few minutes. A "successfully published to Stage" email from Zoho Creator confirmed that the version was published, with the current version shown as 1.1. The Stage application was then opened from the Environments page, and the loan application form displayed the new note, confirming that the change had reached Stage.



Fig. 5 — Publish to Stage initiated

Step 6 Publish the tested version to Production

After testing in Stage, the tested version (Bank Loan Application Form – Initial, V1.1) was published to Production using the Publish Now option. The Environments page was used to track the publishing process.

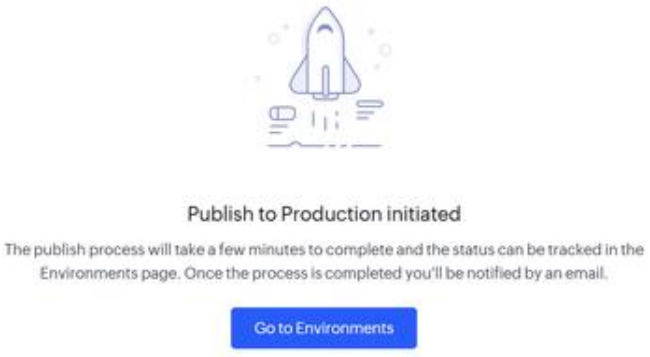


Fig. 7 — Publish to Production initiated

Step 7 Verify the live application

After a few minutes, the Environments page was checked. It showed Stage at version 1.1 and Production at version 1.1, with “No changes available” against the application.

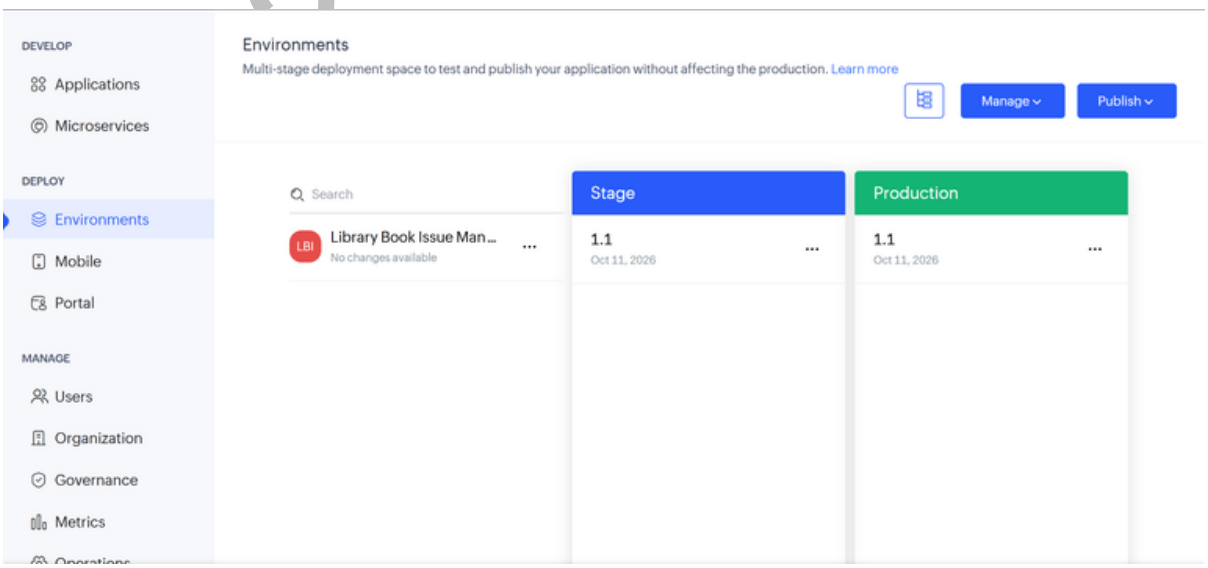


Fig. 8 — Environments page after deployment — Stage 1.1 and Production 1.1

5. Output and Observations

This section records what was observed at each stage. The screenshots are included once, in the corresponding procedure steps above, and are referred to here by figure number.

5.1 Multi-stage deployment flow

The application moved from Development to Stage and then to Production, one environment at a time. Changes were published from Development as V1.1, tested in Stage as version 1.1, and then released to Production as version 1.1, as shown in the deployment diagram in Section 3.1.

5.2 Application dashboard

The Development dashboard displayed charts and summary tiles for the loan applications, including the applications pending and applications rejected tiles

5.3 Environments page

The Environments page listed the Stage and Production columns. Production initially held version 1.0, and the Stage column showed “Waiting for development app creation” while the Development copy was being set up. After the small change was saved in the loan application form, the label “Changes available” appeared

5.4 Component selection and code comparison

The modified note field (plain) was selected from Forms → loan application → Fields in the Publish to Stage window. The side-by-side view showed the updated note text in the Development code and the earlier text in the Staging code (Fig. 3, Step 3).

5.5 Publish details

The release was entered with the title Bank Loan Application Form – Initial, a description of the initial deployment to Stage for testing, the Minor version type, and the version change from V1.0 to V1.1 (Fig. 4, Step 4).

5.6 Stage confirmation

Zoho Creator displayed “Publish to Stage initiated”, and the completion email confirmed that the version had been published to Stage with current version 1.1. The loan application form in Stage displayed the new note (Fig. 5, Step 5).

5.7 Production deployment and live status

The tested version was published to Production using the Publish Now option (Fig. 7, Step 6). The Environments page then showed Stage and Production both at version 1.1, with “No changes available” against the application (Fig. 8, Step 7).

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6. Deployment Summary

Environment	Version	Status	Description
Development	1.1	Published	Note added to the loan application form; no pending changes
Stage	1.1	Deployed	Version tested in Stage; updated note displayed on the form
Production	1.1	Live	Version published to Production after Stage testing

7. Deployment Practices Followed

The deployment followed the practices below, as documented in the source record.

No.	Practice	Purpose
1	Reviewed the modified component before publishing	To check which component, the note field, was being released.
2	Compared Development and Staging code before deployment	To see the updated note text in Development against the earlier text in Staging.
3	Tested the updated application in Stage before Production	To confirm that the change reached Stage before the version was released to live users.
4	Provided a clear publication title and description	To make the release identifiable and its purpose clear.
5	Selected the Minor release type	To record the change as a minimal change and bug fix, moving the version from V1.0 to V1.1.
6	Enabled email notification and checked the Stage confirmation email	To receive confirmation that the version was published to Stage with current version 1.1.
7	Noted the maintenance-mode warning before publishing	To be aware that the application would be inaccessible until publishing was complete.
8	Verified the environments and version numbers after publication	To confirm on the Environments page that Stage and Production were at version 1.1.

8. Final Result

The Bank Loan Application Form application was deployed through the Zoho Creator multi-stage process. The modified note field of the loan application form was reviewed and published from Development to Stage as a Minor release, progressing from V1.0 to V1.1. The Stage deployment was confirmed by the Zoho Creator completion email, and the application was tested in Stage before the version was published to Production. The Environments page showed Stage and Production at version 1.1.